

are crisp and clear without any hisses or background disturbance”.

For most users the player offers a useful array of equalisers, playlist and skinning features. And for the advanced users there are an incredible number of plugins available that allow everything, from special sound effects to letting you play almost every audio format available.

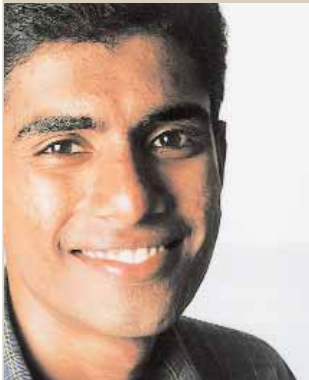
Sanjay Bhuneja occasionally uses Sonique and says that while the default skins and display look good, “changing the skin settings in Sonique completely changes the look”. Many users would find this complete change in appearance very confusing, especially when you consider that there are three different types of views. Winamp skins, on the other hand, are easier to get accustomed to because the buttons remain in the same position.

Since all Windows PCs come with Windows Media Player installed, it probably makes sense to use this software to play your favourite music. However, version 7 of this media player is pretty heavy on system resources.

Says Bhuneja, “While it does have good features and is a comprehensive media player (plays audio, video, radio), I think it uses substantially more system resources, which gave me some problems on a low configuration PC, especially when I used visualisations”. For those

of you who upgraded to version 7 and are not completely satisfied, you can still access the 6.x version by going to Start>Run and typing in mplayer2.

All things considered, however, Winamp scores over other audio player software available



“To play music I use only Winamp because it has numerous features and is very user friendly”

[Rhean D'Souza](#)

Student

when you consider its compactness, the large variety of skins available and the ease of use factor.

Wanna be a DJ?

If you have a collection of CDs that you have to keep popping into your CD-ROM drive every time you want to listen to some tunes, then it probably makes sense to keep the music files on